



► MASCHINENGEWEHR 42

Date 1942

Origin Germany

Barrel 21in (53.3cm)

Caliber 7.92 × 57mm

A successor to the MG34 (below), the MG42 had an extraordinarily high rate of fire—over 1,200 rounds per minute—and was capable of sustained long-range fire when used with a tripod. It featured a recoil-actuated automatic traverse mechanism, which moved the gun's butt slightly to the left and right when firing, allowing the weapon to spray bullets over a small arc and a large target area.